

Katie Lynn Cantwell Butterfield

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Sociology (2021)

University of California, Merced

Dissertation: *Community Gardens, Structural Inequalities, & Health: From Participation to Representation*

Chair: Dr. Zulema Valdez

M.A. in Sociology (2016)

University of California, Merced

Thesis: *Effects of Racial & Class Neighborhood Composition on Community Garden Outcomes*

Chair: Dr. Zulema Valdez

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Quantitative Methods, Sustainable Food Systems, Community Gardens, Food Access, Social Inequality, Rural Health, Health Disparities

TEACHING INTERESTS

Introductory & Advanced Statistics, Research Methods, Data Presentation & Mapping, Health Disparities, Sociology of Food, Rural Sociology

RESEARCH TOOLS & SKILLS

R, RStudio, ArcGIS, Qualtrics, STATA, QualCoder, SAS, ATLAS.ti, SQL, linear & logistic regression, structural equation modeling, multi-level modeling, geographic information system, spatial analysis & regression, online surveys, remote interviews, content analysis

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Researcher (Fall 2023 – Present)

University of California, Davis – Agricultural Sustainability Institute

Academic Supervisor: Dr. Ryan E. Galt

Lead a mixed-methods project exploring market data use/needs & pricing strategies in California's organic agrifood industry. Explore trends in adoption of organic food production across California.

Supporting Grants:

U.S. Department of Agriculture Agricultural Marketing Service (23-SCPMN-CA-0003)

University of California Multi-campus Research Programs & Initiatives (M25PR9207)

Research Data Analyst II (2021 – 2023)

California Department of Social Services – CalFresh & Nutrition Branch

Tracked various quantitative metrics & led multiple quantitative projects that directly informed leadership's work to improve equitable food access in California, including a multi-level modeling analysis of the effectiveness of county business practices.

Graduate Student Researcher (Spring 2021)

University of California, Merced

Academic Supervisor: Dr. Zulema Valdez

Supported the curation of web resources on faculty diversity in hiring & retention & the development of assessment tools & evaluative research for related programs.

Staff Research Associate (Summer 2020)

University of California, Merced

Academic Supervisor: Dr. Whitney Pirtle

Drafted a structural equation model to clarify how racial identity mediates the relationship between racial discrimination & poor health.

Staff Research Associate (Summer 2015; Summer 2019)

University of California, Merced

Academic Supervisor: Dr. Zulema Valdez

Led a mixed-methods project exploring the experiences & values of community gardeners & the perceived health impacts of their garden participation.

Graduate Student Researcher (Fall 2017)

University of California, Merced

Academic Supervisor: Dr. A Susana Ramirez

Performed factor analysis & linear & logistic regressions to assess the relationship between perceptions of neighborhood health & attributions of health responsibilities.

Staff Research Associate (Spring 2015)

University of California, Merced

Academic Supervisors: Dr. Nella Van Dyke & Dr. Kyle Dodson

Collected & cleaned missing values from a nation-wide historical dataset on hate crimes & related laws. Compiled & prepared data for analysis.

PUBLICATIONS

Butterfield, Katie L., & Ryan E. Galt. 2026. "New Estimates Show the First Decline in California's Organic Share of Cropland." *California Agriculture: The Journal of University of California Agriculture & Natural Resources* 80(September). doi:[10.3733/001c.167210](https://doi.org/10.3733/001c.167210).

- Butterfield, Katie L., Ryan E. Galt, & Houston Wilson. 2026. "Improving USDA's Public Price & Volume Data for an Equitable Organic Food Value Chain." *Journal of Agriculture, Food Systems, & Community Development* 15(3):1–24. doi:[10.5304/jafscd.2026.153.013](https://doi.org/10.5304/jafscd.2026.153.013).
- Butterfield, Katie L., & Kathryn P. Daniels. 2025. "Community Gardens Support Stress Coping & Health – A Comparison of Rural & Urban Perceptions of Benefits." *Wellbeing, Space & Society* 9:100297. doi:[10.1016/j.wss.2025.100297](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.wss.2025.100297).
- Butterfield, Katie L., Ryan E. Galt, & Houston Wilson. 2024. *Organic Data Initiative Gap Analysis – California*. University of California, Davis, Agricultural Sustainability Institute & University of California Organic Agriculture Institute.
- Butterfield, Katie L. 2023. "Modeling Community Garden Participation: How Locations & Frames Shape Participant Demographics." *Agriculture & Human Values* 40:1067–85. doi: [10.1007/s10460-022-10406-2](https://doi.org/10.1007/s10460-022-10406-2).
- Marin, Nefertari, Brittany Oakes, & Katie Butterfield. 2021. "[Changing the World with Community Gardens: A study of community gardens & community garden nonprofits across the United States](#)". ArcGIS Online Story Map
- Butterfield, Katie L., & A. Susana Ramírez. 2021. "Framing Food Access: Do Community Gardens Inadvertently Reproduce Inequality?" *Health Education & Behavior* 48(2):160–68. doi: [10.1177/1090198120950617](https://doi.org/10.1177/1090198120950617).
- Butterfield, Katie L. 2020. "Neighborhood Composition & Community Garden Locations: The Effect of Ethnicity, Income, & Education" *Sociological Perspectives* 63(5):738–63. doi: [10.1177/0731121420908902](https://doi.org/10.1177/0731121420908902).

MANUSCRIPTS IN PROGRESS

- Butterfield, Katie L., Ryan E. Galt, & Houston Wilson. "Pricing Decisions & Power Dynamics in California's Organic Agrifood Industry."
- Butterfield, Katie L. "Fundamental Cause Theory & Community Gardens: Evidence of Countervailing Mechanisms."
- Butterfield, Katie L., & Ryan E. Galt. "Organic Production Across California: 2007 – 2022."
- Butterfield, Katie L., Ryan E. Galt, & Houston Wilson. "Data-Informed Decision-Making in California's Organic Agrifood System."
- Butterfield, Katie L. with Brittany Oakes & Zulema Valdez. *All Things to All People: Community Gardens in the United States*. (monograph)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Fellow / Instructor of Record (2018 – 2020)

University of California, Merced

Introduction to Sociology (Summer 2018; Summer 2019; Summer 2020)

This course provides an introduction to applying the “sociological imagination” & exploring how individual behaviors are influenced by society.

Statistics for Sociology (Spring 2019; Spring 2020)

This course introduces the logic & use of statistical techniques in social research, including descriptive, comparative, & inferential statistics, & the use of applicable software (SPSS, SAS).

Advanced Race & Ethnicity (Fall 2018; Fall 2019)

This course examines in depth the main classical & modern explanations of the issues surrounding race & ethnicity.

Sociology of Race & Racism (Spring 2018)

This course provides insight into how race & racism define our lives through systemic & structural racism, racial categorization, ethnic identification, nativism, & intersecting oppressions.

Teaching Assistant (2014 – 2017)

University of California, Merced

Graduate Statistics I (Spring 2017)

This course in social statistics is required of graduate students in Sociology & takes a systematic approach to the general linear model for continuous dependent variables.

Sociological Research Methods (Spring 2016)

This course provides students with a basic understanding of how to conduct social science research.

Statistics for Sociology (Spring 2015, Fall 2016)

This course introduces the logic & use of statistical techniques in sociological research.

Advanced Race & Ethnicity (Fall 2015)

This course examines in depth the main classical & modern explanations of the issues surrounding Race & Ethnicity.

Introduction to Sociology (Fall 2014)

This course introduces the study of groups, culture, collective behavior, classes & caste, community & ecology, role, status, & personality.

PRESENTATIONS

- 2026 “Tracking organic agriculture is easier said than done” with Ryan E. Galt, 2026 American Association of Geographers Annual Meeting
- 2026 “Data & Democracy” with Ryan E. Galt, Soledad Castro, & Santiago Alvarez, 2026 American Association of Geographers Annual Meeting, organized paper session
- 2025 “Pricing Decisions & Power Dynamics in California’s Organic Agrifood Industry” with Ryan E. Galt & Houston Wilson, Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society
- 2025 “California Organic, Agroecological, & Regenerative (COAR) Transitions Project: Trends in Organic Agriculture in California, 1992-2022” with Ryan E. Galt, Jahalel Lee Tuil, & Kase Wheatley, EcoFarm, poster presentation
- 2024 “California Organic, Agroecological, & Regenerative (COAR) Transitions Project: Trends in Organic Agriculture in California, 1992-2022” with Ryan E. Galt, Jahalel Lee Tuil, & Kase Wheatley, California Climate & Agriculture Summit, poster presentation
- 2024 “All Things to All People: Community Gardens in the United States” with Brittany Oakes & Zulema Valdez, Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society, poster presentation
- 2024 “California Organic Data Collection Gap Analysis” Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society
- 2021 “Community Gardening in the United States” with Brittany Oaks & Zulema Valdez, Grow Grant Conference
- 2021 “Community Garden Accessibility: Impacts of Frames & Locations” Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society
- 2021 “Community Gardening in the United States” with Brittany Oaks & Zulema Valdez, Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society
- 2019 “Community Gardens, Investments, & Health Outcomes” American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Round Table 26. Places, Housing, & Health
- 2019 “Health Benefits of Urban Vs. Rural Community Gardens” Annual Meeting of the Rural Sociology Society
- 2019 “Community Gardens, Structural Inequalities, & Health: Urban Vs. Rural Community Gardens” Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society

- 2016 “The Effects of Racial & Class Neighborhood Composition on Community Garden Outcomes” Annual Meeting of the American Public Health Association, poster presentation
- 2016 “Straddling Two Worlds: Does Visiting Home Help or Harm First Generation Students' College Engagement?” with Irene Beattie & Wendy Puquirre. Annual Conference of the Sociology of Education Association
- 2015 “The Effects of Race & Class on Community Garden Locations” Annual Meeting of the Pacific Sociological Association

INVITED TALKS

- 2026 “Improving USDA’s Public Price & Volume Data for an Equitable Organic Food Value Chain” with Ryan E. Galt & Houston Wilson, Organic Pricing Data webinar, Rodale Institute
- 2026 “Organic Data Recommendations” with Ryan E. Galt, Krista Marshall, Neha Sanghera. & Vivian Wauters, California Organic Products Advisory Committee Sep 2026 meeting
- 2026 “Careers Beyond Academia Panel” University of California, Merced, Sociology Graduate Student Committee, Professional Development Panel
- 2018 “Community Gardens, Inequality, & Health” University of California, Merced, Blum Center Summer Institute
- 2017 “Race, Class, & Community Garden Locations” Lyceum Lunchtime Speaker Series, University of California, Merced Health Sciences Research Institute

FELLOWSHIPS & GRANTS

- 2021 University of California, Merced, Global Food Initiative Campus Collaborative Grow Grant
- 2015-2019 Summer Sociology Graduate Student Support Award
- 2018 University of California, Merced, Blum Center Seed Funding
- 2015-2017 Sociology Graduate Student Travel Award
- 2016 University of California Global Food Initiative Fellowship
- 2015 John & Victoria Elia Fellowship

AWARDS & CERTIFICATES

- 2016 & 2020 University of California, Merced, Graduate Division Winter Dissertation Writing Boot Camp

2019	Sociology Graduate Student Service Award
2019	Sociology Conference Paper Presentation Award
2015	University of California, Merced, Center for Research on Teaching Excellence Certificate in General Pedagogy: Mastering the Classroom with First Generation College Students
2015	Inter-University Consortium for Political & Social Research Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research Workshop: Intro to Spatial Regression Analysis

SERVICE

2025-Present	Reviewer, Journal of Agriculture, Food Systems, & Community Development
2023-Present	Reviewer, Agriculture & Human Values
2023-Present	Reviewer, Urban Forestry & Urban Greening
2025	Reviewer, Environmental Evidence
2025	Reviewer, Journal of Hunger & Environmental Nutrition
2025	Reviewer, Acta Sociologica
2019-2021	Organizer, University of California Community Economies Network
2020-2021	Volunteer, Code for America
2018-2019	Internal Graduate Student Representative, Sociology Graduate Student Committee, University of California, Merced
2017-2019	Graduate Student Representative, Healthy Campus Network Committee, University of California, Merced
2017-2018	President, Sociology Graduate Student Committee, University of California, Merced
Fall 2017	Volunteer, Insight Garden Program
Fall 2016	Graduate Student Representative, Faculty Senate Committee on Academic Planning & Resource Allocation, University of California, Merced
Fall 2016	Academic Affairs Officer, Graduate Student Association, University of California, Merced
2015-2016	Sociology Delegate, Graduate Student Association, University of California, Merced

MEMBERSHIPS

2017-Present	Agriculture, Food, & Human Values Society
2017-Present	Caucus of Women in Statistics
2026	American Association of Geographers
2016-2019	Rural Sociological Association
2014-2016 & 2019	American Sociological Association
2015-2016	Pacific Sociological Association